



Week 1 Lecture 8

▼ Class	BSCCS2003
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🔗 Materials	
# Module #	8
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What is a Protocol?

- When both sides agree on how to talk
- Server expects "requests"
 - Nature of requests
 - Nature of client
 - Types of results that the client can deal with
- Client asks "responses"
 - Asks server for something
 - Convey what you can accept
 - Read the result and process

HyperText Transfer Protocol (HTTP)

- Primarily text based
- Requests specified as "GET", "POST", "PUT", etc
 - Headers can be used to convey acceptable response types, languages, encoding
 - Which host to connect to (if multiple hosts are there on a single server)
- Response headers
 - convey message type, data
 - cache information

- status codes: 404 not found, etc

Use cases

- **GET**: simple requests, search queries, etc
- **POST**: more complex form data, large text blocks, file uploads
- **PUT / DELETE / ...**
 - Rarely used in Web 1.0
 - Extensively used in Web 2.0
 - Basis of most APIs - REST, CRUD

Another web server

```
$ python -m http.server
```

- Serve files from local directory
- Understands basic HTTP requests
- Gives more detailed headers and responses

When the above command is run in a given directory, if I find a file called *index.html*, return me that file else return me the directory listing